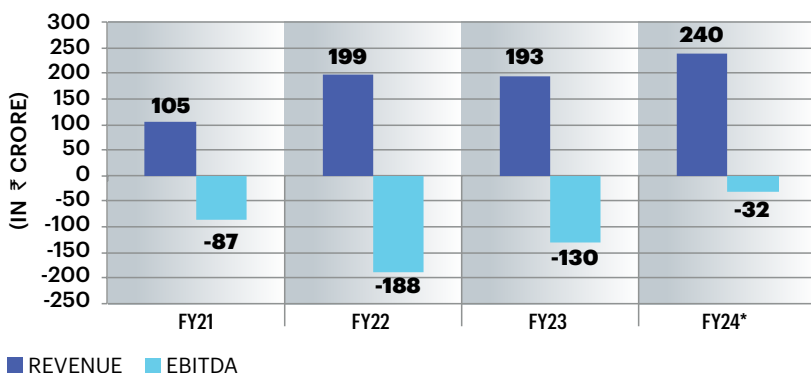


NARROWING LOSSES

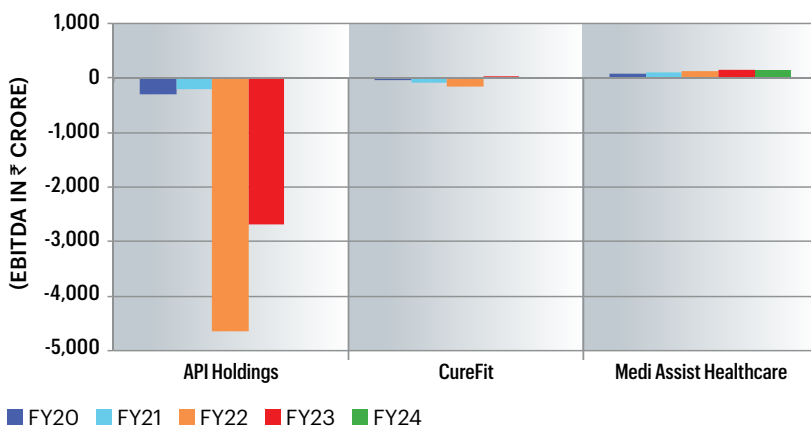
- Practo's revenue has grown to ₹240 crore in FY24 from ₹105 crore in FY21
- Its operational loss has also shrunk in the past two years



NOTE FIGURES ARE FOR PRACTO PTE, WHICH REFLECTS PRACTO'S CONSOLIDATED BUSINESS ACROSS INDIA AND INTERNATIONAL MARKETS; *NUMBERS ARE BASED ON MANAGEMENT FINANCIALS AND ARE UNAUDITED **SOURCE** COMPANY

THE COMPETITION

- In India, digital platforms offering health tracking, teleconsultations, and customised wellness plans have gained popularity, particularly after Covid-19



SOURCE PROWESS

Tier 1 metros, following a shift in consumer behaviour driven by increased affordability and enhanced awareness. “The premiumisation trend in Tier II and Tier III cities is noteworthy, especially following Covid-19, which prompted many people to relocate,” says Shashank. “People in these cities now aspire for branded, higher-quality products and services,” he says.

Abhinav Lal cited the penetra-

tion of smartphones and the affordability and access to high-speed internet. “In healthcare, it is not about being the fastest possible care, but it is about being the highest quality of care. And at Practo, we use data and technology to help our customers find the best care for their healthcare needs,” says Lal.

Shashank says that, as affordability increases, more private hospitals are opening branches in

Tier II and Tier III cities.

For Practo, premiumisation is a big opportunity. “While we previously focused on the Top 10 cities, we now have the chance to expand into 60-70 cities and deepen our presence. We’re already established in these areas but are expanding further to meet this growing demand.”

Practo’s rivals are also getting into the underserved regions, offering everything from online pharmacies to teleconsultations.

Satish Kannan, Co-founder and CEO of Medibuddy, which provides teleconsultations, online pharmacy, lab tests, and cashless hospitalisation services, sees digitalisation reshaping India’s healthcare landscape as innovations improve access, convenience and quality care.

The biggest beneficiaries will be those in underserved regions, says Kannan. “Video consultation has become our fastest-growing category,” Kannan says. “Health checks, diagnostics, and online pharmacies are expanding swiftly.”

LEVERAGING TECH

Practo Ray was launched when internet access was limited, but doctors liked it because it got them online, enabling virtual patient interactions, says Shashank.

Practo is looking at how AI can help bridge language barriers in healthcare. “AI can seamlessly translate and facilitate this interaction, ensuring that language is no longer a barrier to receiving quality care,” says Shashank.

Shashank says AI can help doctors record appointments, take detailed notes, work out treatment plans, and write prescriptions. Practo can use AI to help collect, use and analyse data, validate doctor credentials, audit healthcare facili-